NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TEACHER: _____

KEY TOPIC 3 • 1558–1588

Elizabethan Society in the Age of Exploration, 1558–88



HISTORICAL PRIMARY RECORD: A Chief of the Secotan (Carolina Algonquian) (1585) **BRITISH MUSEUM • 1906,0509.1.21 • LONDON**

EXAM FOCUS **Q1(a) Feature:** 2m [3 min] • **Q1(b) Feature:** 2m [3 min] • **Q2 Causation:** 12m [18 min] **TARGET GRADE:**

PEARSON EDEXCEL GCSE SPECIFICATION FRAMEWORK • KEY TOPIC 3

4 MODULAR ENQUIRIES

TOPIC 3.1 • EDUCATION AND LEISURE

- Education in the home and schools.
- Sport, pastimes and the theatre.

TOPIC 3.2 • THE 'PROBLEM' OF THE POOR

- The reasons for the increase in poverty and vagabondage during these years.
- The changing attitudes and policies towards the poor.

TOPIC 3.3 • EXPLORATION AND VOYAGES OF DISCOVERY

- Factors prompting exploration, including the impact of new technology on ships and sailing and the drive to expand trade.
- The reasons for, and significance of, Drake's circumnavigation of the globe.

TOPIC 3.4 • ATTEMPTED COLONISATION OF VIRGINIA

- Reasons for the attempted colonisation of Virginia, including the significance of Raleigh.
- Reasons for the failure of the first settlement in Virginia.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 1: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 3)

Instructions: As you study each enquiry lesson, complete the timeline missions by sketching and annotating in the corresponding dual-coding sketchpads below.

1572 • The Vagabonds Act

Key Topic 3.2

Parliament passes the 1572 Vagabonds Act, creating a legal distinction between the 'deserving poor' (elderly and sick) and 'idle beggars'. Vagrants over 14 are whipped and burned through the ear; repeat offenders face execution.

1576 • Act for Relief of the Poor & Burbage Builds 'The Theatre'

Key Topic 3.1

The 1576 Poor Act orders town councils to provide wool and raw materials to put the unemployed to work, creating 'Houses of Correction' (Bridewells). In the same year, actor James Burbage constructs 'The Theatre' in Shoreditch, launching Elizabethan public drama.

1577 • Grammar School Expansion & Humanist Curriculum

Key Topic 3.1

Over 70 new grammar schools are founded during Elizabeth's reign. The sons of the gentry and yeomanry study Latin, Greek, rhetoric, and classical history from dawn to dusk, fostering a highly literate administrative and legal class.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 2: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 3)

Instructions: Complete the dual-coding sketches to permanently anchor these chronological turning points in long-term memory.

1577–1580 • Drake's Circumnavigation & Scientific Sailing

Key Topic 3.3

Using new navigation technology including the astrolabe, magnetic compass, and quadrant, Francis Drake navigates through treacherous waters, claims 'Nova Albion' (California) for Elizabeth, and returns with a 4,700% return for his financial backers.

1584 • Raleigh Granted Royal Patent for Virginia

Key Topic 3.4

Elizabeth grants Sir Walter Raleigh a royal charter to discover and colonise 'remote heathen and barbarous lands'. Raleigh names the territory 'Virginia' in honour of the Virgin Queen, raising funds from London merchants for private colonisation.

1585–1586 • The First Roanoke Settlement & Failure

Key Topic 3.4

107 male colonists under Ralph Lane settle Roanoke Island. The flagship Tiger grounds, ruining seed crops; relations with Chief Wingina turn violent, and when Francis Drake arrives in June 1586, the starving colonists abandon the settlement.

Did Elizabethan education and leisure reflect a true "Golden Age" for all social classes?

1 1558–1580s

Attitudes to Education & Literacy

- Literacy at 30% for Men & 10% for Women
- Petty Schools & Dame Schools for Basics
- Reinforcing Great Chain of Being

Why did Elizabethan attitudes towards social hierarchy limit educational opportunity?

2 1558–1580s

Grammar Schools

- Over Seventy New Endowed Schools Founded
- Latin Grammar & Classical Rhetoric Curriculum
- Social Mobility for Middling Sons

How did grammar schools provide a route for sons of the gentry and merchants to rise in society?

3 1558–1580s

Universities & Noble Education

- Private Tutors in Noble Households
- Oxford & Cambridge College Expansions
- Inns of Court London Legal Training

How did the education of the nobility differ from schooling provided to the middling classes?

4 1558–1580s

Sports and Pastimes by Social Class

- Hunting, Hawking & Fencing for Elites
- Violent Folk Football & Archery for Commoners
- Universal Paris Garden Bear-Baiting

How did leisure pursuits reflect both deep social divisions and shared national culture?

5 1576–1588

Development of the Theatre

- Burbage Builds 'The Theatre' at Shoreditch
- Penny Groundlings Mingle with Box Gentry
- Puritans Condemn Immorality & Plague Risk

Why did the theatre attract enormous popularity while provoking intense Puritan opposition?

"The Theatre (1576): The first permanent playhouse in London, built outside the city walls in Shoreditch."

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 18 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 2 (1HI0/2B)

Score: / 12

Explain why education expanded in Elizabethan England. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer: • Grammar schools • Humanist ideas ***(You must also use information of your own.)***

ACCESSIBLE WRITING FRAMES:

One main reason was that... • For example, ... • This was important because... • Another key factor was... • In particular, ... • Overall, the most decisive reason was... because...

KEY VOCABULARY BANK:

Grammar Schools • Latin & Humanist Curriculum • Petty Schools • Dame Schools • Gentry and Yeomanry • Printing Press Literacy • Oxford & Cambridge • Social Mobility • Protestant Bible Reading

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on facing page)

Enquiry 3.1: Education and leisure in Elizabethan England • Question 2 Explain Why Continued

Score: / 12

Conclude your question 2 explain why and provide your sustained historical verdict below:

• QUESTION 1 PRACTICE: DESCRIBE ONE FEATURE [2 × 2M = 4 MARKS • 6 MINS]

Q1 Total: / 4

Q1(A) **EDEXCEL JUNE 2018 (Q1A)** **Mark: / 2**

Describe one feature of Elizabethan grammar schools. [2 marks]

Target: AO1 (2m) • *Feature: One key feature was that... • Detail: Specifically, this was evident when...*

Q1(B) **EDEXCEL NOVEMBER 2020 (Q1A)** **Mark: / 2**

Describe one feature of Elizabethan theatres. [2 marks]

Target: AO1 (2m) • *Feature: One key feature was that... • Detail: Specifically, this meant that...*

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 2). In Milestone 2, sketch James Burbage's 'The Theatre' with groundlings in the pit and nobility in the galleries. ← **Pages 2–3**

"Extended writing: analyse how Elizabethan education reinforced rigid social class hierarchies."

Why did poverty and vagrancy become the greatest domestic fear in Elizabethan society?

1 1558–1580s

Population Growth & Rising Prices

- Population Surges from 3m to Over 4m
- Consecutive Bad Harvests Inflate Grain Prices
- Falling Real Wages for Farm Labourers

How did the relationship between population growth and food supply generate severe poverty?

2 1558–1580s

Changes in Farming: Enclosure & Sheep

- Wool Accounts for 80% of English Exports
- Hedging Common Land for Low-Labour Flocks
- Eviction of Strip-Farming Tenant Cottagers

Why did the expansion of sheep farming cause widespread rural unemployment and eviction?

3 1558–1570s

Changing Attitudes to the Poor

- Harman's Caveat for Common Cursitors Book
- Impotent Poor Versus Sturdy Beggars
- Dread of Social Unrest & Treasonous Riot

Why did Elizabethan authorities draw such a sharp distinction between the 'deserving' and 'idle' poor?

4 1572

The 1572 Vagabonds Act

- Compulsory Parish Poor Rate Tax
- Overseers Appointed to Distribute Relief
- Ear-Boring with Hot Iron for Repeat Vagrants

How did the 1572 Act combine harsh criminal punishment with the first compulsory tax for relief?

5 1576

The 1576 Act for Relief of the Poor

- Parishes Provide Raw Wool, Flax & Hemp
- County Bridewells Compel Hard Labour
- Foundation for Comprehensive 1601 Poor Law

Why did the 1576 Act represent a major shift in the state's responsibility for unemployment?

Question 3: Evaluative Essay [16 marks + 4 marks SPaG • 25 mins]

EDEXCEL PAPER 2 (1HI0/2B)

Score: / 20

"The main reason for the increase in poverty in Elizabethan England was bad harvests." How far do you agree? Explain your answer. [16 marks + 4 marks SPaG]

You may use in your answer: • Enclosure of land • Population growth ***(You must also use information of your own.)***

ACCESSIBLE WRITING FRAMES:

To a large extent, it can be argued that... • A decisive factor supporting this view was... • Specifically, this was important because... • On the other hand, an alternative perspective is that... • In particular, ... • In conclusion, the decisive reason was... because...

KEY VOCABULARY BANK:

Population Rose (3m to 4m) • Enclosure of Common Land • Sheep Farming Conversion • Debasement of Coinage • 1572 Vagabonds Act • Impotent Poor vs Sturdy Beggars • 1576 Poor Act • Houses of Correction (Bridewells) • Compulsory Poor Rates

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on facing page)

"1576 Act for Relief of the Poor: Local parishes provided wool and hemp so the unemployed could work."

Score: / 20

Conclude your question 3 evaluative essay and provide your sustained historical verdict below:

• QUESTION 1 PRACTICE: DESCRIBE ONE FEATURE [2 × 2M = 4 MARKS • 6 MINS]

Q1 Total: / 4

Q1(A) EDEXCEL JUNE 2019 (Q1A) — Mark: / 2

Describe one feature of the 1572 Vagabonds Act. [2 marks]

Target: AO1 (2m) • *Feature: One key feature was that... • Detail: Specifically, this was evident when...*

Q1(B) EDEXCEL JUNE 2022 (Q1A) — Mark: / 2

Describe one feature of the 1576 Act for Relief of the Poor. [2 marks]

Target: AO1 (2m) • *Feature: One key feature was that... • Detail: Specifically, this meant that...*

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 1). In Milestone 1, sketch the branding iron of the 1572 Vagabonds Act alongside the wool stockpiles of the 1576 Poor Act. ← Pages 2–3

Did Drake circumnavigate the globe for geographic science, national glory, or legalised piracy?

1 1558–1575

New Navigational Technology

- Astrolabes & Quadrants Measure Latitude
- Mercator Projection Global Maps (1569)
- Navigation Away from Known Coastlines

How did advances in navigational science make oceanic exploration feasible for English captains?

2 1558–1577

Improvements in Ship Design

- Low Forecastles & Triangular Lateen Sails
- Culverin Cannons on Four-Wheel Carriages
- Manoeuvrable Tacking in Severe Atlantic Weather

How did changes in galleon design and gun placement give English sailors an advantage at sea?

3 1550s–1570s

The Search for New Trade Routes

- Collapse of Antwerp Cloth Market (1550s)
- Muscovy & Levant Joint-Stock Companies
- Frobisher & Davis Arctic Northwest Search

Why did English merchants establish joint-stock companies to explore new global trade routes?

4 1577–1580

Drake's Circumnavigation

- Pelican Renamed Golden Hind at Horn
- Strait of Magellan Gale Storm Survival
- Claims Nova Albion (California) for Crown

Why was Drake's voyage through the Strait of Magellan and across the Pacific an extraordinary achiev

5 1580–1588

Significance of Drake's Voyage

- £140,000 Spanish Bullion Cargo Returns
- 4,700% Financial Profit Pays Crown Debt
- Proves England Can Challenge Spanish Seas

How did the success of Drake's circumnavigation alter England's position on the world stage?

"New navigation tech: The astrolabe measured stars, but Drake's daring navigated the globe."

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 18 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 2 (1HI0/2B) Score: / 12

Explain why Drake circumnavigated the globe in 1577–1580. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer: • Attacking Spanish colonies • Exploring new trade routes ***(You must also use information of your own.)***

ACCESSIBLE WRITING FRAMES:

One main reason was that... • For example, ... • This was important because... • Another key factor was... • In particular, ... • Overall, the most decisive reason was... because...

KEY VOCABULARY BANK:

Francis Drake • Circumnavigation • Pacific Coast Raids • Nova Albion (California Claim) • Spice Islands (Moluccas) • Astrolabe and Magnetic Compass • Galleon Ship Design • 4,700% Investment Return • Knighthood at Deptford

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on facing page)

"Drake was the first Englishman to circumnavigate the earth, returning in 1580 with 4,700% profit."

Enquiry 3.3: Exploration and voyages of discovery • Question 2 Explain Why Continued

Score: / 12

Conclude your question 2 explain why and provide your sustained historical verdict below:

• QUESTION 1 PRACTICE: DESCRIBE ONE FEATURE [2 × 2M = 4 MARKS • 6 MINS]

Q1 Total: / 4

Q1(A) **EDEXCEL NOVEMBER 2021 (Q1B)** **Mark: / 2**

Describe one feature of new navigational technology in the Elizabethan era. [2 marks]

Target: AO1 (2m) • *Feature: One key feature was that... • Detail: Specifically, this was evident when...*

Q1(B) **EDEXCEL JUNE 2021 (Q1A)** **Mark: / 2**

Describe one feature of Drake's circumnavigation of the globe. [2 marks]

Target: AO1 (2m) • *Feature: One key feature was that... • Detail: Specifically, this meant that...*

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 4). In Milestone 4, sketch Drake's route through the Straits of Magellan up to Nova Albion and around the Cape of Good Hope. ← **Pages 2–3**

Why did Walter Raleigh's first American colony at Roanoke collapse into disaster by 1586?

1 1584

Raleigh's Patent & Planning

- Six-Year Patent to Claim Uncharted Land
- Hakluyt's Discourse on Western Planting
- Privateering Base to Intercept Spanish Plate

Why did Raleigh and the Elizabethan court believe an American colony was vital to England?

2 1584–1585

Recruiting Colonists & Leaders

- 107 Gentlemen Soldiers & No Farmers
- Grenville Fleet & Ralph Lane Army Discipline
- Manteo & Wanchese Native Translators

Why did the social composition and skills of the 1585 colonists create severe vulnerabilities?

3 1585–1586

The First Roanoke Colony & Disaster

- Flagship Tiger Runs Aground on Sandbar
- Seawater Ruins Grain Seeds & Provisions
- Disastrous Reliance on Secotan Fish Weirs

How did environmental accidents and food dependency undermine the first Roanoke settlement?

4 1586

Conflict & Evacuation

- Silver Cup Dispute Leads to Village Burning
- Ralph Lane Ambush Kills Chief Wingina
- Drake Arrives to Evacuate Starving Settlers

Why did armed conflict with the Secotan force the complete abandonment of the 1585 colony?

5 1587–1590

The 'Lost Colony' & Significance

- 118 Civilian Settlers Led by John White
- Armada Impounds Supply Ships in England
- 'CROATOAN' Carved on Deserted Palisade

What crucial lessons did the failure of the Roanoke expeditions provide for future English colonies?

Question 3: Evaluative Essay [16 marks + 4 marks SPaG • 25 mins]

EDEXCEL PAPER 2 (1HI0/2B) | **Score: / 20**

"The lack of supplies was the main reason for the failure of the Roanoke colony in 1585." How far do you agree? Explain your answer. [16 marks + 4 marks SPaG]

You may use in your answer:	• Relations with Native Americans	• The damage to the Tiger	***(You must also use information of your own.)***

ACCESSIBLE WRITING FRAMES:

To a large extent, it can be argued that... • A decisive factor supporting this view was... • Specifically, this was important because... • On the other hand, an alternative perspective is that... • In particular, ... • In conclusion, the decisive reason was... because...

KEY VOCABULARY BANK:

Walter Raleigh • Richard Grenville • Flagship Tiger Seawater Ruin • Ralph Lane • Chief Wingina • Roanoke Island • Algonquian Hostility • Late Relief Fleets • Abandonment with Drake

Write your response in the space provided below:

(Response continues on facing page)

"Roanoke failed because the Tiger ruined seeds, supplies arrived late, and relations with Wingina collapsed."

 Score: / 20

Conclude your question 3 evaluative essay and provide your sustained historical verdict below:

• QUESTION 1 PRACTICE: DESCRIBE ONE FEATURE [2 × 2M = 4 MARKS • 6 MINS]

Q1 Total: / 4

Q1(A) **EDEXCEL JUNE 2018 (Q1B)** **Mark: / 2**

Describe one feature of Walter Raleigh's plans for colonising Virginia. [2 marks]

Target: AO1 (2m) • *Feature: One key feature was that... • Detail: Specifically, this was evident when...*

Q1(B) **EDEXCEL NOVEMBER 2020 (Q1B)** **Mark: / 2**

Describe one feature of the failure of the 1585 Roanoke settlement. [2 marks]

Target: AO1 (2m) • *Feature: One key feature was that... • Detail: Specifically, this meant that...*

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 5). In Milestone 5, sketch the grounded flagship Tiger losing its seed grain and gunpowder on the Outer Banks. ← **Pages 2–3**

THE HISTORY DEPARTMENT • ASSESSMENT & PROGRESS RECORD

KEY TOPIC 3 ASSESSMENT & HOMEWORK RECORD

PUPIL: _____ **TARGET GRADE:** [ ] **PREDICTED:** [ ] **ATTITUDE:** 1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5

MASTER EXAM PRACTICE & HOMEWORK ASSESSMENT TRACKER • KEY TOPIC 3

#	ENQUIRY & SPECIFICATION TOPIC	PAGE	EXAM PRACTICE QUESTION & FOCUS	HOMEWORK DEADLINE	MARK AWARDED
3.1	ENQUIRY 3.1: EDUCATION AND LEISURE IN ELIZABETHAN ENGLAND Spine Lecture Notes (p. 4): / 10	p. 5–6	**Q2 Explain Why:** Explain why education expanded in Elizabethan England. [12 marks] [12m]	___/___	/ 12
		p. 6	**Q1(a) Feature:** Elizabethan grammar schools [2m]		/ 2
		p. 6	**Q1(b) Feature:** Elizabethan theatres [2m]		/ 2
		Summary	Total Module Enquiry Assessment Mark		/ 16
3.2	ENQUIRY 3.2: THE 'PROBLEM' OF THE POOR Spine Lecture Notes (p. 7): / 10	p. 8–9	**Q3 Essay:** "The main reason for the increase in poverty in Elizabethan England... [20m]	___/___	/ 20
		p. 9	**Q1(a) Feature:** the 1572 Vagabonds Act [2m]		/ 2
		p. 9	**Q1(b) Feature:** the 1576 Act for Relief of the Poor [2m]		/ 2
		Summary	Total Module Enquiry Assessment Mark		/ 24
3.3	ENQUIRY 3.3: EXPLORATION AND VOYAGES OF DISCOVERY Spine Lecture Notes (p. 10): / 10	p. 11–12	**Q2 Explain Why:** Explain why Drake circumnavigated the globe in 1577–1580. [12 marks] [12m]	___/___	/ 12
		p. 12	**Q1(a) Feature:** new navigational technology in the Elizabethan era [2m]		/ 2
		p. 12	**Q1(b) Feature:** Drake's circumnavigation of the globe [2m]		/ 2
		Summary	Total Module Enquiry Assessment Mark		/ 16
3.4	ENQUIRY 3.4: ATTEMPTED COLONISATION OF VIRGINIA Spine Lecture Notes (p. 13): / 10	p. 14–15	**Q3 Essay:** "The lack of supplies was the main reason for the failure of the Ro... [20m]	___/___	/ 20
		p. 15	**Q1(a) Feature:** Walter Raleigh's plans for colonising Virginia [2m]		/ 2
		p. 15	**Q1(b) Feature:** the failure of the 1585 Roanoke settlement [2m]		/ 2
		Summary	Total Module Enquiry Assessment Mark		/ 24

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ENQUIRY 3.1
Education and leisure in Elizabeth...
Education in the home, schools and unive...

LESSON — Read Online
20-Q QUIZ — Self-Marking

Quiz Attempt: [ ] 1st [ ] 2nd [ ] 3rd
Score: / 20 Date: ___/___

ENQUIRY 3.2
The 'problem' of the poor
Reasons for increase in poverty and vaga...

LESSON — Read Online
20-Q QUIZ — Self-Marking

Quiz Attempt: [ ] 1st [ ] 2nd [ ] 3rd
Score: / 20 Date: ___/___

ENQUIRY 3.3
Exploration and voyages of disco...
Factors prompting exploration • tech...

LESSON — Read Online
20-Q QUIZ — Self-Marking

Quiz Attempt: [ ] 1st [ ] 2nd [ ] 3rd
Score: / 20 Date: ___/___

ENQUIRY 3.4
Attempted colonisation of Virginia
Reasons for attempted colonisation •...

LESSON — Read Online
20-Q QUIZ — Self-Marking

Quiz Attempt: [ ] 1st [ ] 2nd [ ] 3rd
Score: / 20 Date: ___/___